

# Introduction

**T**ablets need no introduction. If you're into tech, you've no doubt been bombarded with ads for tablets. The world's gone portability crazy – what started as simple browsing on your dumb-phone has now transmogrified into an app crazy, bandwidth hungry, touch-enabled world of its own. What the iPhone started, has moved on to become the touchy-feely world of people going ga-ga over tablets. However, most people still believe that the iPad was the first “tablet”, and that the tooth fairy leaves money under your pillow as a reward for spitting out milk teeth... We're here to debunk one of these beliefs, and set you straight with knowledge that you should pass on.

As with anything that's “hot”, just as it happened with mobile phones before this, everyone's jumped on the tablet bandwagon. Now we've got tablets for as cheap as 6K, all the way up to the iPads of the world, and none of them can really hold a candle to the productivity that a laptop or desktop offers – but that's not what you're really looking for when you think “tablet” are you? There's just something to be said for the touch interface that Apple has popularised again, and even kids as young as 3 will vouch for that. It's the natural way of doing things – maybe not editing Excel files, but certainly when browsing through pictures, or even playing “casual” games.

This Fast Track starts you off slow – looking at where it all began, and why it didn't really take off all those years ago. Obviously, it also covers Apple, and the iPad, because honestly, that's the benchmark we all use to decide on whether a device from another manufacturer is really that good. Apple might have had a stranglehold on the touch-based device market if it wasn't for the entrance of Google's offering. Thus we will cover Android and all the major devices that were made possible because of it – which is also why you're so spoiled for choice these days. what Android also did, since it's open source, is open up the world of tablets to the “little guy”,